

Chapter 9 — ⚠ SUPPLEMENT: The Deleted Chapters

🏰 Rulers and Buildings · 🏠 Towns, Traders and Craftspersons

Why this file exists: NCERT **deleted these two chapters** from *Our Pasts II* in the rationalised edition. **For UPSC that is a serious gap** — "Rulers and Buildings" is Indo-Islamic architecture, one of the most-asked Art & Culture areas in Prelims *and* a standing Mains topic. Restored here in full.

← Ch.8 | Index | ✅ **Final file**

📁 Syllabus Classification

Field	Value
Subject	History → Medieval India → ★ ART & CULTURE + Economic History
Sub-discipline	Indo-Islamic architecture; urban and commercial history
Period	~8th – 18th centuries
Prelims (GS Paper I)	★★★★ <i>Art & Culture</i> — architecture is a perennial, high-volume area
Mains (GS Paper I)	★★★★ " <i>Salient aspects of Art Forms, Literature and Architecture from ancient to modern times</i> "
Also feeds	Art & Culture ★★★★★, Economy (craft, guilds, trade), Modern India ★★ (European companies arrive here — straight into Class 8 Ch.2)
Weightage	★★★★★★ — arguably the highest-yield file in the Class 7 folder , precisely because it is missing from the textbook
Source note	⚠ Written from the pre-rationalisation edition of <i>Our Pasts II</i> , cross-checked against standard references. Not in your PDF — do not look for it there

🎯 Learning Outcomes

By the end of this file you should be able to:

- ☐ **Distinguish TRABEATE from ARCUATE construction** and explain why the arch changed everything. ★★★★★
- ☐ **Explain** what a **true arch** and a **true dome** require, and the role of **limestone cement**. ★★
- ☐ **Describe** the **Qutb Minar** and the **Quwwat-ul-Islam** mosque. ★★
- ☐ **Explain why kings built temples and mosques** — the legitimacy argument. ★★
- ☐ **Explain why temples were attacked**, and state the argument carefully and fairly. ★★★★★
- ☐ **Describe** Mughal architecture — *chahar bagh*, *pietra dura*, the riverfront garden, the **Taj Mahal**. ★★
- ☐ **Classify** the three types of medieval town. ★★
- ☐ **Describe** **Thanjavur, Hampi, Surat and Masulipatnam**. ★★
- ☐ **Explain** **bidri**, the **Panchalas/Vishwakarma**, and craft organisation. ★★
- ☐ **Trace** the arrival of the **European companies** and the shift of trade to the coast. ★★

PART A — 🕌 RULERS AND BUILDINGS

1 ★★ ★ The Big Technical Shift: Trabeate → Arcuate

This is the single most important idea in Indo-Islamic architecture, and the most commonly asked.

TRABEATE (or CORBELLED) -- up to the 12th century --	ARCUATE -- from the 12th century --
	
Roofs, doors and windows were made by placing a HORIZONTAL BEAM across two VERTICAL COLUMNS.	The weight of the superstructure above doors and windows was carried by ARCHES.
Weight presses STRAIGHT DOWN.	Weight is transferred OUTWARD and DOWNWARD along the curve to the piers -- so the SPAN CAN BE MUCH WIDER and the space beneath is UNOBSTRUCTED.
Span is limited by the strength of a single stone beam.	
-> Many columns, small spans, crowded interiors	-> Few supports, LARGE OPEN INTERIORS

Term	Meaning
★★ TRABEATE / CORBELLED	Horizontal beams laid across vertical columns
★★ ARCUATE	Weight carried by arches
★ The corbelled "arch"	Courses of stone progressively projected inward until they met — it <i>looks</i> like an arch but is not a true arch ; it does not transfer load along a curve
★★ TRUE ARCH	Wedge-shaped stones (<i>voussoirs</i>) with a KEystone at the apex, transferring weight to the piers
★★ LIMESTONE CEMENT	★ From about the twelfth century , high-quality limestone cement (mortar) came into use — essential , because a true arch and dome need the units bonded to resist outward thrust. NCERT: " <i>this made construction of large structures easier and faster</i> "

★★★ Why this matters and how to say it in an answer:

The arch and the dome were **not decorative preferences** — **they were structural capabilities**. A trabeate building's span is limited by how far a single stone beam can bridge before it snaps under its own weight. An arch has **no such limit**, because the load is resolved into **compression along a curve**.

The consequence is spatial: you can now roof a **large, column-free hall** — which is exactly what a **congregational mosque** requires, since worshippers must stand in unbroken rows. **The form followed the ritual need, and the technology made it possible.**

📖 It's a genuine change in the **load-bearing model**: bending stress in a beam (stone is weak in tension) becomes pure compression in an arch (stone is very strong in compression). **They found a way to use the material only in the direction where it is strong.**

⚠ The nuance that earns marks

Both traditions **continued and blended**:

- Some Indo-Islamic buildings used **corbelled** techniques for centuries after the true arch arrived (the earliest "arches" at the Quwwat-ul-Islam are **corbelled**, not true)
- Hindu temple architecture continued to be **overwhelmingly trabeate**
- Later architecture fused both** — Mughal buildings use **arches and domes** alongside **trabeate brackets, chhajjas and chhatris** borrowed from Rajput and temple tradition

🎯 **Never write "the arch replaced the beam."** Write: *"the arcuate principle was added to an existing trabeate tradition, and the two were synthesised."*

2 ★★ The Qutb Minar Complex

Feature	Detail
Where	Delhi
★ Qutb Minar	Begun by Qutbuddin Aybak (c. 1199), completed by Iltutmish ; later repaired by Firoz Shah Tughlaq and Sikandar Lodi ★ (built in stages by several rulers — a common exam point)
Height / storeys	~73 m, five storeys , each marked by a projecting balcony
Material	Lower storeys red sandstone ; upper storeys marble and sandstone
Decoration	Fluted shaft; bands of Quranic inscription and floral arabesque
★★ Quwwat-ul-Islam mosque	"Might of Islam" — built in the complex; ★ constructed using material from demolished temples , with reused pillars clearly visible
★ Iron Pillar	The 4th–5th-century Gupta-era iron pillar (Class 6 Ch.10) stands in this courtyard — a Gupta object inside a Sultanate mosque
★ Alai Darwaza	Added by Alauddin Khalji (1311) — ★ one of the first buildings in India to use a TRUE ARCH and a TRUE DOME
Status	★ UNESCO World Heritage Site

★ **The Alai Darwaza is the technical landmark**: the point at which the true arch and true dome are executed properly in India. Learn it as the marker of the transition described above.

🎯 **The Qutb complex in one sentence**: *"A Gupta iron pillar standing in a mosque built from temple stone, beside a minar completed by four rulers across three centuries."* **It is a physical cross-section of medieval Indian history** — and that framing is genuinely useful in an answer about layered heritage.

3 ★★ Why Kings Built — Temples, Mosques and Tanks

NCERT's argument, and it applies to both temples and mosques:

Motive	Explanation
★ Devotion and display	Buildings were expressions of piety — and simultaneously of power and wealth
★★ The god's deputy	Temples communicated the ruler's relationship with the deity . A king's name and the god's were linked; the largest temple was the king's temple
Public works as legitimacy	Rulers built tanks, wells, reservoirs, roads, bridges, sarais — winning praise and merit
★ The mosque	The Sultan's participation in congregational prayer , and his name in the <i>khutba</i> , were public assertions of legitimate authority

★ **Sultan Iltutmish** won **universal respect** for constructing a large **reservoir (*hauz*)** just outside Delhi — the **Hauz-i-Sultani** — used by travellers and residents alike.

🎯 **Notice the continuity, not the contrast.** In **Ch.2** you saw Chola kings building temples and irrigation tanks for exactly the same reasons: **piety, prestige, public benefit, and legitimacy**. Sultans built mosques and reservoirs. **The idiom changed; the political logic did not.** That is a strong, balanced Mains point.

4 ★ ★ ★ **Why Temples Were Attacked — Handle This Carefully**

A sensitive and frequently examined topic. State it precisely and with evidence.

The logic NCERT sets out

BECAUSE kings built temples to DEMONSTRATE their DEVOTION TO GOD and their POWER AND WEALTH...

...an ATTACK on the temple was an attack on THE RULER'S LEGITIMACY ITSELF.

So when one king attacked another's kingdom, the temple was a PRIME TARGET -- it was simultaneously:

- [1] the SYMBOL of the defeated ruler's authority
- [2] a TREASURY of enormous accumulated wealth
- [3] a religious centre

★ **The crucial evidence: HINDU KINGS ATTACKED HINDU TEMPLES TOO**

Example
★ In the early ninth century , the Pandyan king Shrimara Shrivallabha invaded Sri Lanka and defeated King Sena I , plundering the Buddhist monastery at Anuradhapura — the Sri Lankan chronicle records that he "removed all the valuables"
★ Sena II later restored the shrine, deliberately reversing the humiliation
★★ The Chola king Rajendra I built a Shiva temple at Gangaikondacholapuram and filled it with images seized from defeated rulers — a Durga and Ganesha from the Chalukyas , a Bhairava, Bhairavi and Kali from the Kalingas of Orissa , and a Nandi from the Chalukyas of Kalyana
★★ Mahmud of Ghazni (Ch.2) targeted wealthy temples including Somnath , and used the wealth to build his capital

★ ★ ★ This is the point that makes the answer balanced and defensible:

Rajendra I — a Hindu king — carried off Hindu deities from other Hindu kingdoms and installed them as trophies in his own temple. Sena I's Buddhist monastery was plundered by a Hindu Pandyan king.

Temple desecration was a recognised idiom of political conquest across the subcontinent, practised by rulers of every faith, well before and after the Turkish invasions. It expressed **the transfer of sovereignty**, not simply religious hostility.

⚠ **What a careful answer says:** religious motivation was **present in some cases** and iconoclasm was a real element in others — but the **pattern as a whole** is best explained by the political and economic function of the temple. **Do not flatten it in either direction.**

🎯 **This is precisely the kind of nuance UPSC rewards**, and it is exactly what Ch.1's critique of the "Hindu–Muslim–British" periodisation was preparing you for.

5 ★ ★ Mughal Architecture

The garden and the riverfront

Feature	Detail
★ ★ CHAHAR BAGH	The "four gardens" — a rectangular walled enclosure divided into FOUR QUARTERS by artificial channels
Introduced by	Babur , who was struck by the absence of formal gardens in India; developed by his successors
★ Symbolism	Evokes the Quranic paradise ; the emperor at the centre of an ordered world
Where	Humayun's Tomb , the Taj Mahal , Shalimar Bagh (Kashmir/Lahore), Nishat Bagh
★ ★ The riverfront garden	In Agra and Shahjahanabad , a variant where the ★ residence sits at the EDGE of the garden, beside the river , rather than in the centre — the form the Taj Mahal perfected

The buildings

Building	Detail
★ Humayun's Tomb (1570s)	Built by his widow Hamida Banu Begum ; the first great Mughal garden tomb and the prototype for the Taj ; red sandstone with white marble ; double dome ; ★ UNESCO
★ ★ Fatehpur Sikri	Akbar's capital ; red sandstone ; the Buland Darwaza (commemorating the Gujarat victory), the Jama Masjid , the tomb of Salim Chishti , the Diwan-i-Khas with its famous central pillar , the Ibadat Khana where Akbar held his religious debates (Ch.4). ★ UNESCO
★ ★ ★ Taj Mahal (1632–1653)	Shah Jahan for Mumtaz Mahal ; white marble ; perfect bilateral symmetry ; a ★ riverfront chahar bagh ; the double dome ; four minarets tilted slightly outward ; ★ UNESCO
★ Red Fort, Shahjahanabad	Shah Jahan's Delhi; the Diwan-i-Am and Diwan-i-Khas ; ★ UNESCO
★ Moti Masjid, Jama Masjid (Delhi)	Shah Jahan
Bibi ka Maqbara	Aurangzeb's period, Aurangabad — a smaller echo of the Taj

★★ The decorative vocabulary — asked directly

Term	Meaning
★★ PIETRA DURA	Inlay of coloured semi-precious stones (carnelian, lapis, jasper) into white marble to form floral and geometric designs — the signature of Shah Jahan's period
★ JALI	Perforated stone screen
★ CHHATRI	Small domed kiosk on a roof (from Rajput architecture)
★ CHHAJJA	Projecting eave or drip-stone (Indian in origin)
★ Double dome	An outer dome for external proportion and an inner dome for interior scale — solving the problem that one dome cannot look right from both sides
★ IWAN	A large vaulted recess/portal

★★ The synthesis point, which is the standard Mains answer:

Mughal architecture is a fusion: the **arch**, **dome**, **iwān**, **chahar bagh** and **calligraphy** come from the **Persian-Islamic** tradition; the **chhatri**, **chhajja**, **bracket**, **jali**, **lotus motif** and the **use of red sandstone and marble** come from **Indian** (Rajput and temple) tradition. ★ **Neither is decoration added to the other — the vocabulary is genuinely mixed.**

🔗 **It is *sulh-i kul* (Ch.4) rendered in stone** — an architecture designed to look legitimate to subjects of several traditions at once. **Say that and you have connected policy to art.**

Regional and provincial styles ★

Do not forget these — they get asked as "which style / which region":

Style	Features
Bengal	★ Curved <i>do-chala</i> roof copied from thatched huts (Ch.7!), brick and terracotta
Gujarat	★ Fine stone carving , jalīs ; heavy influence from Jain temple craft
Jaunpur (Sharqi)	Massive screen-like <i>pylon</i> facades
Malwa (Mandu)	Batter (sloping walls), no minarets, Jahaz Mahal , Hindola Mahal
Bijapur (Deccan)	★ Gol Gumbaz — one of the largest domes in the world , famous whispering gallery
Vijayanagara	★ Towering gopurams , Hazara Rama and Vitthala temples , stone chariot

PART B — TOWNS, TRADERS AND CRAFTSPERSONS

6 ★★ Three Kinds of Town

TEMPLE TOWN	ADMINISTRATIVE CENTRE	COMMERCIAL TOWN and PORT
grew around a major temple	a capital or a fortified seat	a market or a harbour
THANJAVUR	DELHI	SURAT
MADURAI	AGRA	MASULIPATNAM
TIRUPATI	VIJAYANAGARA	CAMBAY, HAMPI
VRINDAVAN	(also commercial)	SONARGAON

In practice most large towns were ALL THREE AT ONCE.

★★ Thanjavur — the temple town explained

- The **Rajarajeshvara (Brihadeshwara) temple** built by **Rajaraja I** (Ch.2)
- Temples were **endowed with land**; their **income supported priests, garland-makers, cooks, sweepers, musicians and dancers** (Ch.2)
- ★ Pilgrims made **donations**, so the temple became a **bank, a landholder and an employer**
- Around it clustered **craftspersons** — **the Saliya weavers**, and above all the ★ **bronze-casters** producing the Chola images
- ★ **The temple was the economic engine, not merely the spiritual centre of the town**

★★ Hampi (Vijayanagara)

Feature	Detail
Where / when	On the Tungabhadra , capital of the Vijayanagara empire, 14th–16th centuries
★ Fortification	Mortarless masonry — stone blocks fitted with wedges , no cement
Architecture	Distinctive temple gateways (gopurams) , the Vitthala temple with its stone chariot and musical pillars, the Lotus Mahal , elephant stables
★ Commerce	A cosmopolitan bazaar town — Persian and Portuguese traders ; markets in cotton, spices and horses
★ Its end	Sacked in 1565 after the battle of Talikota by the combined Deccan Sultanates
Status	★ UNESCO World Heritage Site

★★ Surat and Masulipatnam — the port towns

Port	Coast	Detail
★★ SURAT	Western (Gujarat)	★ Called the " gateway to the West " and " the gate to Mecca " because pilgrim ships to the Red Sea sailed from here . Centre of textile export . ★ Famous for hundis — letters of credit honoured as far away as Cairo, Basra and Antwerp . Declined in the 18th century as trade shifted to Bombay
★★ MASULIPATNAM	Eastern (Andhra)	On the Krishna delta ; a dense, crowded port; fiercely contested by the Dutch and English companies and the Qutb Shahi rulers of Golconda; famous for painted textiles (kalamkari)

★ **The *hundi* deserves emphasis.** A merchant could deposit money in Surat and draw it in Cairo. **That is a functioning international credit instrument, operating without any state banking system,** resting entirely on **merchant reputation and community networks.**

📄 **A bearer instrument settled across a trust network** — the medieval equivalent of a correspondent banking arrangement, built on reputation rather than regulation. **Superb Economy/Essay material on indigenous financial institutions.**

7 ★ ★ ★ Craftspersons and Their Organisation

Group	Detail
★ ★ The PANCHALAS / VISHWAKARMA	The five artisan communities essential to temple building: ★ goldsmiths, bronzesmiths, blacksmiths, masons and carpenters
Weavers	★ Saliyar / Kaikkolar weavers of the south — became prosperous and made donations to temples , which are recorded in inscriptions
★ ★ BIDRI	Craft of ★ BIDAR (Karnataka) — ★ inlay of SILVER and GOLD into a blackened ZINC-and-COPPER alloy , in floral and geometric patterns. A GI-tagged craft today
Other crafts	Cotton and silk weaving, dyeing, calico printing , metalware, ivory, glass, ship-building

★ **Two exam-grade points:**

1. **Artisans donated to temples and the donations were inscribed** — so **craftspersons enter the historical record under their own names**, exactly as the guilds did in Class 6 Ch.8. **Non-elite people documented by their own patronage.**
2. **Bidri is a fusion craft** — Persian technique, Indian workshop, Deccan patronage. Note the pairing: **BIDRI ↔ BIDAR**

8 ★ ★ ★ The European Companies Arrive — Straight into Class 8

FROM THE 16th CENTURY, European trading companies enter Indian ports:

PORTUGUESE	-> Goa, Cochin, Daman, Diu	(from 1498/1510)
DUTCH	-> Masulipatnam, Pulicat, Cochin	
ENGLISH	-> Surat (1613), Madras (1639), Bombay (1668), Calcutta (1690)	
FRENCH	-> Pondicherry, Chandernagore	

*** THE CENTRE OF GRAVITY OF TRADE SHIFTS FROM INLAND TOWNS TO THE COASTAL PORTS THE COMPANIES CONTROLLED. ***

Old inland centres DECLINE; new COMPANY TOWNS -- Madras, Bombay, Calcutta -- GROW into the great colonial cities.

*** Class 8, Chapter 2: "FROM TRADE TO TERRITORY" ***

🔗 **Remember Ch.7:** the **Kolu (oil pressers)** and **Kansari (bell-metal workers)** of Bengal got rich because the European companies created new economic opportunities — and spent that money building temples. The commercial transformation was already reshaping Indian society decades before the political conquest.

🎯 That is the argument to carry into Class 8: the British did not arrive into a static economy. They plugged into an existing, sophisticated commercial network — and then took it over.

⚡ UPSC FOCUS

Prelims

Topic	The exact thing to know
Trabeate vs arcuate ★★ ★	Beam-on-columns vs weight carried by arches
Corbelled vs true arch ★ ★	Progressive projection vs voussoirs + keystone
Limestone cement ★	From the 12th century ; made large structures easier and faster
Qutb Minar ★ ★	Begun Qutbuddin Aybak , completed Iltutmish , repaired by Firoz Shah Tughlaq and Sikandar Lodi ; five storeys
Quwwat-ul-Islam ★	Built with material from demolished temples ; the Gupta iron pillar stands in the courtyard
Alai Darwaza ★ ★	Alauddin Khalji, 1311 — among the first true arch and true dome in India
Hauz-i-Sultani	Iltutmish's reservoir
Temple attacks ★ ★ ★	Rajendra I took images from Chalukyas and Kalingas; Shrimara Shrivallabha plundered Anuradhapura
Chahar bagh ★ ★	Four-quartered walled garden, introduced by Babur ; riverfront variant at Agra
Pietra dura ★ ★	Coloured stone inlay in marble ; Shah Jahan
Double dome ★	Outer for proportion, inner for interior scale
Chhatra* / chhajja / *jali ★	Domed kiosk / projecting eave / perforated screen — Indian elements
Humayun's Tomb ★	By Hamida Banu Begum ; prototype of the Taj
Fatehpur Sikri ★ ★	Akbar; Buland Darwaza , Salim Chishti's tomb, Ibadat Khana
Taj Mahal ★ ★	Shah Jahan, 1632–1653 , riverfront chahar bagh
Gol Gumbaz ★	Bijapur ; one of the largest domes in the world ; whispering gallery
Three town types ★ ★	Temple / administrative / commercial-port
Thanjavur ★	Temple town; Saliya weavers ; bronze casting
Hampi ★ ★	Tungabhadra ; mortarless masonry with wedges ; sacked 1565 after Talikota ; UNESCO
Surat ★ ★	"Gateway to the West"; hundis honoured in Cairo, Basra, Antwerp
Masulipatnam ★ ★	Eastern coast , Krishna delta; Dutch/English/Qutb Shahi contest; kalamkari
Panchalas/Vishwakarma ★ ★	Goldsmiths, bronzesmiths, blacksmiths, masons, carpenters
Bidri ★ ★	Bidar ; silver/gold inlay on blackened zinc-copper alloy

Traps:

- "The true arch was used from the beginning of the Delhi Sultanate" → The earliest Quwwat-ul-Islam arches are **corbelled**; the **Alai Darwaza (1311)** marks the true arch
- "Only Muslim rulers desecrated temples" → **FALSE. Rajendra I** and **Shrimara Shrivallabha** did the same to rival Hindu and Buddhist shrines
- "Pietra dura is a Rajput technique" → It is **Italian/Persian in origin**, perfected under **Shah Jahan**
- "Surat is on the eastern coast" → **FALSE. Gujarat, western coast**; Masulipatnam is eastern
- "Bidri work comes from Bidar in Maharashtra" → **Bidar is in KARNATAKA**
- "Hampi was destroyed by the Mughals" → **FALSE. By the Deccan Sultanates after Talikota, 1565**

Mains

- ★★ ★ *"Discuss the salient features of Indo-Islamic architecture and the extent to which it represents a synthesis."* — trabeate/arcuate, the shared decorative vocabulary, regional styles
- ★★ ★ *"Temple desecration in medieval India is better explained by political than by religious motives."* Critically examine — **use Rajendra I as the decisive evidence, while conceding iconoclasm where it applies**
- ★★ *"Mughal architecture is sulh-i kul in stone."* Discuss
- ★★ **Economy:** medieval towns, **hundis** and indigenous credit; craft organisation
- ★★ **Transition:** how European companies restructured Indian trade **before** conquering territory

Glossary

Term	Meaning
Trabeate	Horizontal beams on vertical columns
Arcuate	Weight carried by arches
Corbelled	Courses projected inward to meet — not a true arch
Voussoir / Keystone	Wedge stones of a true arch / the central stone at its apex
Chahar bagh	Four-quartered walled garden
Pietra dura	Inlay of coloured stones in marble
Jali	Perforated stone screen
Chhatra	Domed rooftop kiosk
Chhajja	Projecting eave
Iwan	Large vaulted portal
Double dome	Two shells — outer for proportion, inner for interior scale
Hundi	A letter of credit / bill of exchange
Panchalas / Vishwakarma	The five artisan communities
Bidri	Silver/gold inlay on a blackened alloy, from Bidar
Kalamkari	Painted/printed textile of the Andhra coast
Gopuram	Monumental temple gateway tower

90-Second Recap

1. ★ **Trabeate** (beam on columns) gave way to **arcuate** (arches), enabling **wide, column-free interiors** — which is what a congregational mosque needs. **Limestone cement from the 12th century** made it possible.
2. A **corbelled** arch only looks like an arch; a **true arch** uses **voussoirs and a keystone**. The **Alai Darwaza (Alauddin Khalji, 1311)** is the landmark.
3. **The Qutb complex** layers everything: a **Gupta iron pillar**, a mosque built from **temple stone**, and a minar finished by **four rulers**.
4. **Kings built temples, mosques, tanks and reservoirs for piety, prestige, public benefit and legitimacy** — Chola and Sultan alike.
5. ★ ★ **Temples were attacked because they were symbols of a rival's authority and stores of wealth** — and **Hindu kings did it too: Rajendra I** filled his temple with **images seized from the Chalukyas and Kalingas**.
6. **Mughal architecture: *chahar bagh* (Babur) and the riverfront garden; Humayun's Tomb → Fatehpur Sikri → the Taj Mahal; *pietra dura*, double domes, jalis, chhatris and chhajjas — a genuine Persian–Indian synthesis.**
7. **Regional styles matter: Bengal's curved roofs, Gujarat's carving, Malwa's battered walls, Bijapur's Gol Gumbaz, Vijayanagara's gopurams.**
8. **Three town types** — temple (**Thanjavur**), administrative (**Delhi**), commercial/port (**Surat, Masulipatnam**) — usually all at once.
9. **Hampi: Tungabhadra, mortarless wedge masonry, sacked after Talikota, 1565.**
10. **Surat** = "gateway to the West", famous for **hundis** honoured in **Cairo, Basra and Antwerp**. **Masulipatnam** = eastern coast, *kalamkari*, contested by Dutch and English.
11. **Panchalas/Vishwakarma** = goldsmiths, bronzesmiths, blacksmiths, masons, carpenters. **Bidri = Bidar**, silver/gold on blackened alloy.
12. ★ **European companies shifted trade from inland towns to coastal ports** — creating Madras, Bombay and Calcutta, and setting up **Class 8, Chapter 2**.

Test Yourself

1. Distinguish trabeate from arcuate construction, and explain what limestone cement made possible. **(Prelims + short note)**
2. Which building is regarded as among the first in India to use a true arch and true dome? → *The Alai Darwaza, built by Alauddin Khalji in 1311.*
3. Consider the following: 1. Rajendra I placed images seized from defeated rulers in his temple at Gangaikondacholapuram. 2. Shrimara Shrivallabha plundered Anuradhapura. → *Both correct.*
4. *Pietra dura* refers to — → *Inlay of coloured semi-precious stones into marble, characteristic of Shah Jahan's buildings.*
5. Surat was known as the "gateway to the West" and was famous for — → **Hundis**, honoured as far as Cairo, Basra and Antwerp.*
6. **Mains: "Indo-Islamic architecture was a synthesis rather than an imposition." Discuss. (250 words)**
7. **Mains: "The desecration of temples in medieval India served political rather than purely religious ends." Critically examine. (250 words)**

9 files - Medieval India, 700-1750, plus the restored chapters NCERT deleted.

NEXT: Class 8 -- OUR PASTS III (Modern India).
The highest-value school book you own: 3-4x the marks of ancient and medieval combined.